

071 Take mushroom spore prints

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MINS

Fungi produce white, yellow, or black spores. Single spores are hard to see, but you can take a print of a whole mushroom. Use lighter or darker posterboard if the print is hard to see.



What you need

- Mature mushroom (from supermarket)
- Colored posterboard
- Glass bowl
- Artists' fixative spray



1 Place a mushroom cap, gill- or pore-side down, on a piece of posterboard. Put the bowl over the cap to protect it from drafts.



2 Leave overnight, then carefully lift the cap from the posterboard. You should now have a spore print.



3 Be careful not to touch your print or it will smudge. Spray the print with fixative in a ventilated room or outdoors, to stop the spores from rubbing off.

White
spore print



072 Make stamps with mushrooms

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MINS

Cut a mushroom cap in half. Dip it into paint or ink and press it gently onto a sheet of paper. By linking the stamps, you can create patterns and different designs.

Use two colors

